

SCANNED DOCUMENT

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In this month's issue, we delve into the ancient ruins of Kael-Thar, where the Crimson Marauders discovered a cache of forgotten arcane artifacts. Among them, the Eye of the Serpent — a crystal orb said to grant its wielder visions of distant lands and hidden truths.

Local sages have cautioned against the use of the artifact, warning that it may exact a terrible price. Three members of the expedition have already fallen to a mysterious wasting sickness. Scholars at the Grand Library of Aethon are racing to decipher the runes carved into the orb's base.

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The expedition leader, Captain Vexandra Thorn, reported that the Eye of the Serpent was found within a sealed sarcophagus bearing the crest of the Serpent King.

Hieroglyphs on the walls tell the story of a great war between the serpentfolk and the dragonlords of old.

As our investigators continue to unravel this mystery, we remind our readers that not all treasure is meant to be claimed. Some knowledge comes at a cost beyond gold.

Next month: An exclusive interview with the Loremaster of the Silver Spire on the nature of arcane contamination.

See appendix B for full transcript of
the hieroglyphic translation —ed.